



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

does free
will explain
all evil?

1. It is possible for all people to have free will and yet never bring about any evil.
 2. God can bring about any possible situation.
-

C. God could have made a world where all people have free will and yet never bring about any evil. (1,2)

Suppose that we reject (2). This raises the question: what is omnipotence, if not the ability to bring about anything possible?

It seems like this is a question to which the proponent of the free will defense owes an answer.

Could we reject (2) instead?

While this sounds odd at first, it fits with an intuitive thought about free will. It is tempting to say that while it is possible for me to freely scratch my nose in a minute, it is not possible for God to bring it about that I freely scratch my nose in a minute — since, if God brought it about, then my nose scratching would not be free.

But this is just a way of denying (2)
— which is (2') in the argument
from pointless evil 2.0 — since it
amounts to saying that there is a
certain possible scenario that God
cannot bring about.

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MACKIE'S ARGUMENT AGAINST THE FWD



possible situation.

and yet never bringing about any

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bringing about any evil.

2: God can bring about any

Ch. Goodread have a world

where all people have free will



envil. (1, 2)

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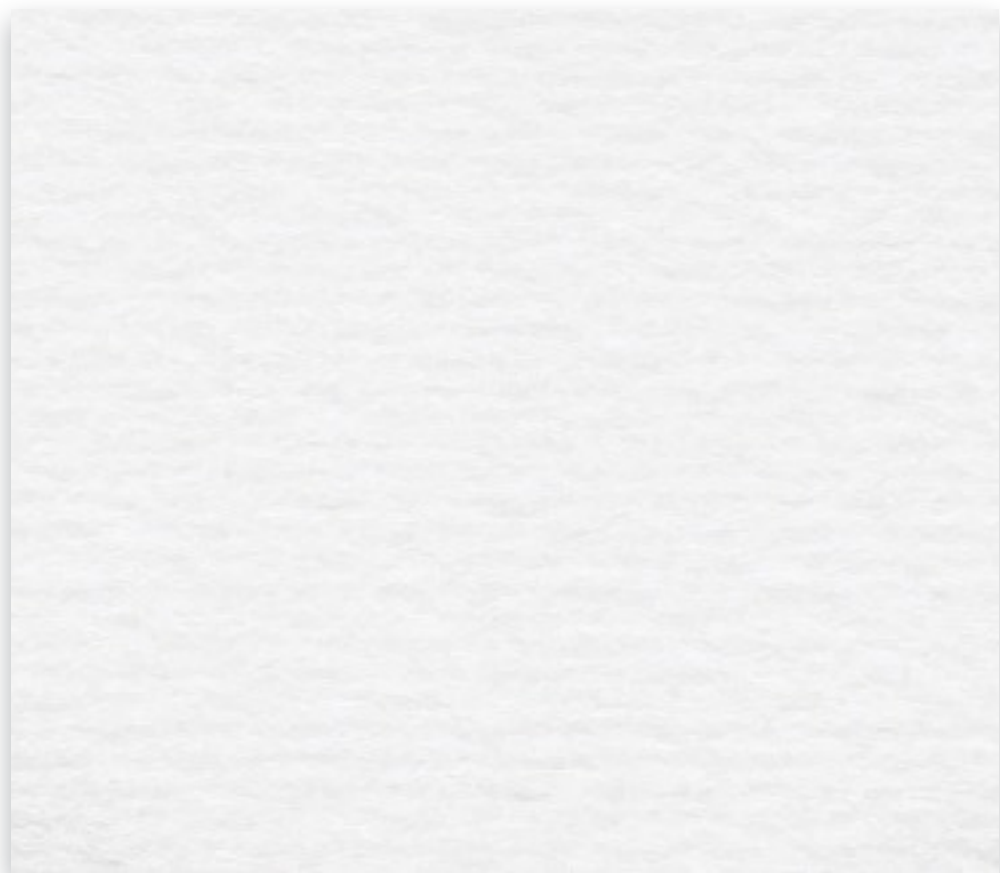
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~~which is $(2')$ in the argument~~

But this is just a way of denying (2)

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people do not have free will

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and yet never bring

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evi1.(1,2)

C. Godeville had made a

have firee will and yet

1. It is possible for all

2. God can bring about any

about array envil.



there could be evil in a world with a omnipotent and perfectly good

God. It can explain that, it seems, if we make the following assumption:

Summing up so far: we have seen that Frege will promise to explain how

there are possible
situations which an
omnipotent
being cannot
bring about



we have
free will



free will is
a great good

the ability
to harm others
is a great good

does free
will explain
any evil?

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "does free will explain all evil?" is written in white, lowercase, sans-serif font, arranged in three lines.

does free
will explain
all evil?



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

**Free will
cannot
explain any
evil.**

Free will can explain some evil; but it can't explain all of the evil we find in the world.

We could try instead:

Consider the action J_{eff} Speaks freely

But this definition seems too strong.

creating a hamburger for lunch. can bring

this about - but God can not.

onenighttry:

But this seems too weak.

A being is omnipotent if it can do anything that it is possible for that being to do.

A being is omnipotent if it can do anything that it is possible for any being to do.

Perhaps:

A being is omnipotent if it is as powerful as it is possible to be.

Suppose that we reject (2). This

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bringing about anything possible?

raises the question: what is